

Alexander Joshua Aleksanyan, Ph.D.

New York University
Grossman School of Medicine
Department of Population Health
180 Madison Avenue
New York, NY 10016
E-mail: joshua.aleksanyan@nyulangone.org
Website: [aja2182.github.io](https://github.com/aja2182)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Fellow, Population Health
NYU Grossman School of Medicine, New York, NY

07/2023 - Present

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Sociology
Columbia University, New York, NY, conferred October 2023

- Dissertation: *States, Selves, & Social Welfare: The American Therapeutic State in Comparative Perspective*
- Committee: Adam Reich (chair), Gil Eyal, Bruce Western, Michelle Phelps, Gerard Torrats-Espinosa

Master of Philosophy, Sociology
Columbia University, New York, NY, conferred October 2022

Master of Arts, Sociology
Columbia University, New York, NY, conferred May 2019

Bachelor of Arts, Sociology
Bard College, Annandale-on-Hudson, NY, conferred May 2014

RESEARCH & TEACHING

substance use and psychiatric health services, organizations, and systems, youth and young adulthood, punishment and social control, welfare and administrative state policy and governance, qualitative and quantitative methods and design

PUBLICATIONS

Shim, K., Knopf, E., **Aleksanyan, J.**, Terplan, M., Martins, S. S., & Choi, S. (2026). Methamphetamine co-use among pregnant individuals using opioids in the United States, 2011–2023. *Obstetrics & Gynecology*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1097/AOG.0000000000006328>

Renteria, D., Fawole, A., Alexandre, J., Allen, H., **Aleksanyan, J.**, Choi, S., ... & Neighbors, C. J. (2026). Too young for medication? Prescriber perspectives on how age shapes medication for opioid use disorder prescribing in transition-age adults. *Harm Reduction Journal*, 23(1), 120.

Drury, V., **Aleksanyan, J.**, Narayanan, N., Echenique, J., Melkonian, M., Renteria, D., ... & Jordan, A. E. (2026). Beyond age: Transition age adults have distinct identities, substance use patterns compared with other adults in substance use disorder treatment. *Journal of Addiction Medicine*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1097/ADM.0000000000001692>

Choi, S., **Aleksanyan, J.**, Knopf, E., Hwee, T., Habersham, L., & West, B. S. (2026). Impact of policies on pregnant individuals using drugs: A narrative synthesis review of treatment, health care access, and outcomes. *Stigma and Health*, 11(1), 61–74.

Aleksanyan, J., Maria, Z., Renteria, D., Fawole, A., Jordan, A. E., Drury, V., ... & Neighbors, C. J. (2025). Perspectives of treatment providers overseeing substance use disorder treatment among transition-age adults, aged 18–25 years. *Journal of Substance Use and Addiction Treatment*, 174, 209704.

Aleksanyan, J., Kawachi, I., & Choi, S. (2025). Reproductive rights at the US state level and medication access for pregnant women with opioid use. *Social Science & Medicine*, 366, 117630.

Aleksanyan, J., Choi, S., Lincourt, P., Burke, C., Ramsey, K. S., Hussain, S., ... & Neighbors, C. J. (2024). Lost in transition: A protocol for a retrospective, longitudinal cohort study for addressing challenges in opioid treatment for transition-age adults. *PLOS ONE*, 19(8), e0297567.

Aleksanyan, J. (2022). Governing beyond the closet: Remaking stigma, identity, and sexual behavior in a post-disciplinary rehab. *Ethnography*, 23(4), 516–538.

Under Review

How Young Adults Negotiate Substance Use Treatment Access, Autonomy, and Developmental Fit. *Journal of Adolescent Health*.

“Real healing happens when we feel heard, not just monitored”: Clinical and social organizational factors that shape substance use engagement of young adults, 18–25, across specialty and peer-led service settings. *Pediatrics*

Initiation, Patterns, and Considerations of Substance Use Change Among Transition-age Adults Across Specialty and Peer-led Substance Use Service Ecologies. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*

Utilizing Administrative Data for Provider Recruitment in Qualitative Research: Insights from a Pharmacy Claims- Based Case Study. *BMC Medical Research Methodology*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Fellow

09/2018 - 05/2023

Department of Sociology, Columbia University, New York, NY

- Developed lesson plans and facilitated weekly student discussion groups for undergraduate courses: *Introduction to Sociology*, *Sociological Theory*, *Global Urbanism*, and *Research Methods*.
- Held weekly office hours, graded over 150 undergraduate students total, provided recommendation letters.

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Multilevel and Mixed Models, *Regression Analysis*, *Longitudinal Analysis*, *Causal Inference*

SKILLS

Natural and Programming Languages: English (native), Russian (passive), R, LaTeX

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, & AWARDS

2023. Postdoctoral Fellowship, NYU Grossman School of Medicine

2023. Bruce D. Johnson Student Paper Award, Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP)

2022. Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Matching Travel Award, Columbia University
 2018. Spivack Travel Award, Columbia University
 2017. Paul F. Lazarsfeld Fellowship, Columbia University
 2020. Interdisciplinary Center for Innovative Theory and Empirics (INCITE) Grant, Columbia University
 2019. Department Grant, Department of Sociology, Columbia University
 2014. Dean Stuart Stritzler-Levine Seniors-to-Seniors Scholarship, Bard College
 2010. Education Opportunity Program (Full-tuition scholarship), Bard College

**MEDIA AND
PUBLIC
ENGAGEMENT**

Quoted Expert, Think Global Health — “The Opioid Use Treatment Young Americans Can’t Access,” August 17, 2026.

**ACADEMIC
TALKS**

“I came in with Less and Less Resources Every Time”: Motivation for Treatment and Recovery among Transition-Age Adults, 18-25, with Substance Use Disorder. NYU Population Health 2026 Trainee Research Day. April 2024. New York, NY.

“Navigating Identity in Transition-Age Adulthood (18-25): Implications for Substance Use Treatment.” NYU Population Health 2026 Trainee Research Day. April 2024. New York, NY.

“Reproductive Rights and Opioid Use Disorder Treatment During Pregnancy.” Department of Population Health Research Seminar, Emerging Leaders in Research Lecture Series. New York University Grossman School of Medicine. November 2024. New York, NY.

“If You Just Give Them a Handbook... You’ve Lost Them’: Perspectives of Treatment Providers Who Oversee Transition-Age Adults, 18-25, with Substance Use Disorder.” Addiction Health Services Research Conference. October 2024. San Francisco, CA.

“Reproductive Rights at the U.S. State Level and Medication Access for Pregnant Women with Opioid Use.” Addiction Health Services Research Conference. October 2024. San Francisco, CA.

“Reproductive Rights Medication for pregnant clients with opioid use disorder: A multilevel approach.” Lifespan/Brown Criminal Justice Research Training Program on Substance Use and HIV (CJRT). New York University Grossman School of Medicine. March, 2024. New York, NY.

“Medication for pregnant clients with opioid use disorder: A multilevel approach.” Lifespan/Brown Criminal Justice Research Training Program on Substance Use and HIV (CJRT). March, 2024. New York, NY.

“Latino Trajectories in the New York State Substance Use Treatment System.” Lifespan/Brown Criminal Justice Research Training Program on Substance Use and HIV (CJRT). New York University Grossman School of Medicine. February, 2024. New York, NY.

“Welfare, Punishment, and the Social Policy of Addiction Treatment.” Society for the Study of Social Problems Annual Conference, Regular Session on Drug Research and the Challenges of Working within the System. August, 2023. Philadelphia, PA.

“Welfare, Punishment, and the Social Policy of Therapeutic Governance.” American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Regular Session on Social Determinants of Health and Well-being among People who Use Drugs. August 2022. Los Angeles, CA.

“From ‘Gay Addicts’ to ‘Sexually Compulsive’: Governing Sexual Marginality in the Age of the New Brain Sciences.” Gender and Sexuality Workshop, Columbia University. October, 2018. New York, NY.

“Nothing is straightforward around here, excuse the pun’: How Healthcare Staff Govern Gay Addicts by Governing Each Other,” Eastern Sociological Society Annual Conference, Regular Session on Organizations and Inequality. February, 2018. Baltimore, MD.

“LGBT Addiction Treatment & Neoliberal Affect,” Dean of Studies & Lifetime Learning Institute, Annual Presentations. May, 2014. Annandale-on-Hudson, NY.

“Men, ‘Gut-check’ and ‘Show Your Strength’: Governing ‘Healthy Masculinity’ Through Men Can Stop Rape Movement,” American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Undergraduate Honors Program. August, 2013. New York, NY.

SERVICE & ACTIVITIES

Award Committee Member, Drugs and Society Section, American Sociological Association, 2027 Trainee, Lifespan/Brown Criminal Justice Research Training Program on Substance Use and HIV, 2024

Panelist, Addiction Health Services Research Conference, 2024

Member, American Sociological Association, 2014-Present

Member, Eastern Sociological Society, 2018-Present

Co-Coordinator, Gender and Sexuality Workshop, Columbia University, 2021

Founding Editor, Dishrag Magazine, 2019-2020

Volunteer, The Osborne Association, 2018-2020

Elected Chair, Multicultural and Diversity Committee, Bard College, 2013-14

Elected Chair, Education Policy Committee, Bard College, 2012-13

Founder, Sociology Lab, Bard College, 2012-14

Journal Reviewer for: *PLoS ONE*, *Social Science & Medicine*, *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*, *Harm Reduction*, *Emerging Adulthood*, *Journal of Adolescent & Child Substance Use*